



Dallas Center-Grimes Community School District

High School

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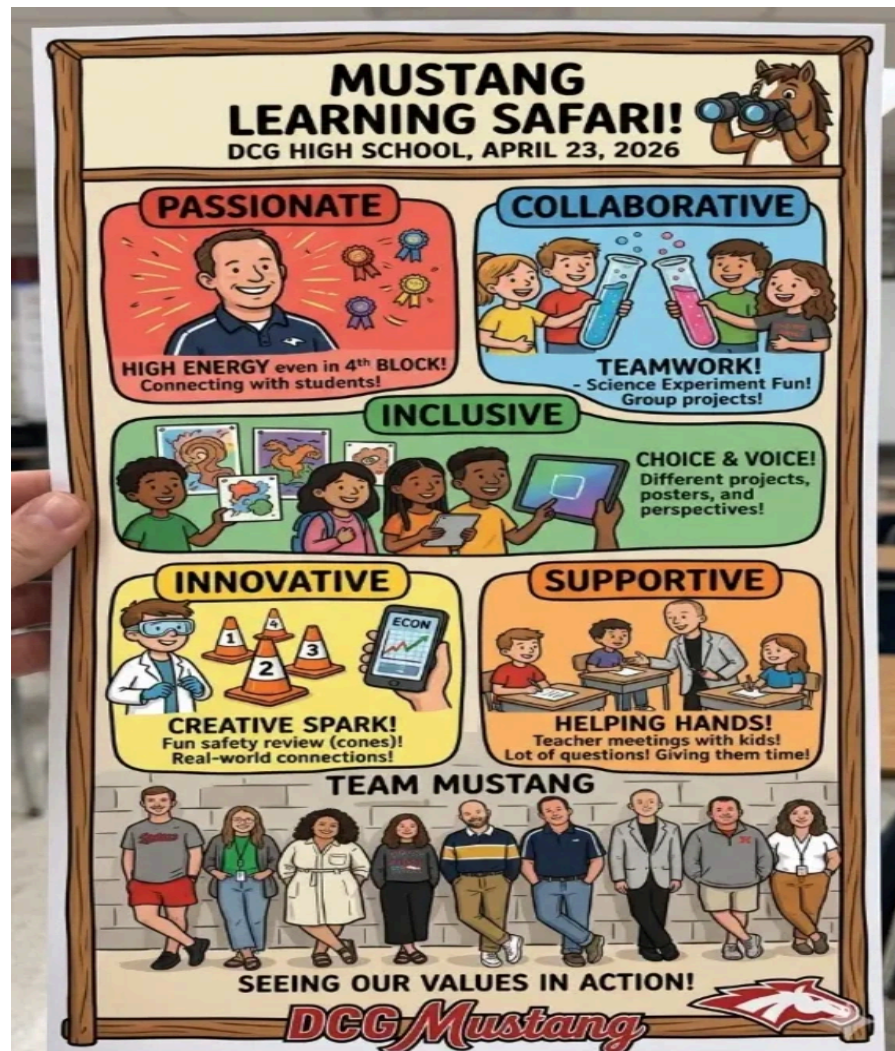
May 2026

DCGCSD School Board Report

Prepared by: Matthew J. Blackmore, High School, Principal

Welcome to the most exciting month of the school year! May is a time for celebration, reflection, and new beginnings. From the final curtain call of our spring play to the long-awaited walk across the graduation stage, our Mustang community has much to be proud of. Please review the important dates and event details below to ensure you don't miss a moment of the action.

Mustang Learning in Action: April Learning Walks



Mustang Learning in Action: April Learning Walks

On Thursday, April 23, 2026, the staff at Dallas Center-Grimes High School engaged in our monthly Learning Walks during the third block. These walks provide a vital opportunity for our educators to visit classrooms, observe instructional excellence, and see our District Core Values come to life in the hands of our students and teachers.

The observations from this month's walks highlighted the incredible ways our school community is growing together:

Collaborative & Innovative

The halls were buzzing with teamwork as students engaged in science experiments and group projects. We observed students "talking with peers" to solve complex problems and utilizing innovative tools—like partner competitions to review safety protocols and the creative use of Smartboards—to make learning both memorable and fun.

Passionate & Supportive

Our educators continue to champion student success with high-energy instruction, even during the final blocks of the day. Our "Supportive" value was on full display through:

- Building Community: Teachers utilizing a "Question of the Day" to foster personal connections.
- Individualized Attention: Educators walking the room to meet with students one-on-one, ensuring everyone has the academic and emotional support they need.
- Patience & Encouragement: Giving students the "think time" they need to process and respond with confidence.

Inclusive Environments

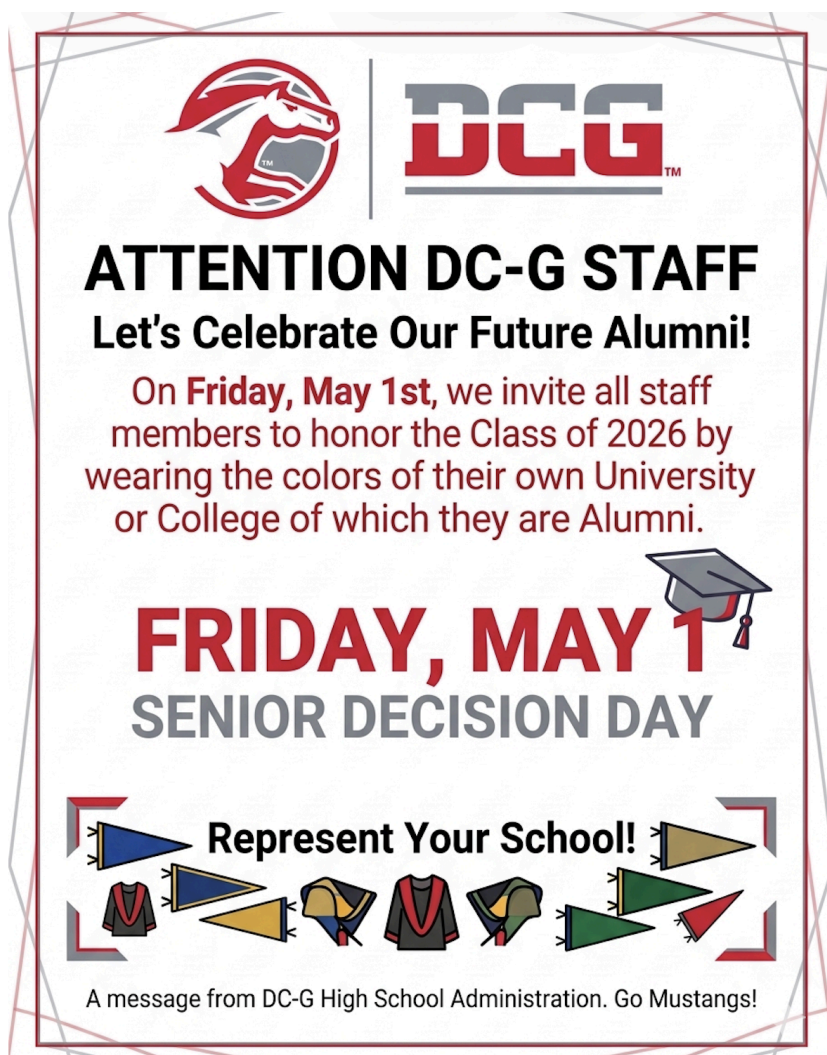
Inclusivity is about empowering every voice. During our walks, we saw classrooms that offered students a choice in how they demonstrate their learning—whether through individual projects, diverse displays, or visual aids. By honoring different learning styles and perspectives, our staff is creating a space where every Mustang feels valued and respected.

A huge thank you to our staff for their vulnerability in opening their classrooms and their commitment to continuous improvement. It was a great day to be a Mustang!

☀ Senior Highlights: The Class of 2026

Senior Decision Day & BBQ | May 1, 11:30 AM

A new tradition begins! Seniors will make their post-secondary declarations at the DCG Stadium. Superintendent Blum, Principal Blackmore, and Director Ellingson will be on hand to celebrate. Special thanks to Mr. Collin Lane, Rylee Renz, and the Grimes Hy-Vee for the Senior BBQ!



Teacher Appreciation Week

On behalf of DCG, thank you to all of our amazing teachers for their service to our students, families and community!

Teacher Appreciation Week (May 4- May 8) starts tomorrow and we'd love your help in celebrating our amazing teachers and staff!

If you'd like to contribute, we are collecting funds via Venmo: *@Monica-Malmberg*. All donations

will go towards:

- Snacks Provided in Teacher Lounges!
- "SIPS" Dirty Sodas on Wednesday at Professional Learning
- DCG Koozies with Gift Cards
- and much more!

Another meaningful way to participate—encourage your students to write a note of appreciation to their teachers during the week!

Thank you for helping us recognize all that our teachers do each day.

Cap & Gown Pickup | May 7, Lunch Hour

Jostens will be in the West Commons. If you haven't ordered yet, email **Shauna.Pertzsch@dcgschools.com** immediately.

Senior Awards Night | May 20, 7:00 PM

Join us in the Auditorium as the DCG Educational Foundation distributes thousands of dollars in scholarships to our deserving seniors.

Seniors' Last Day: Friday, May 15

Commencement Day: Friday, May 22, 2026

Time	Event	Details
8:30 AM	Commencement Practice	Mandatory for all walking graduates. Receive cords, certificates, and mini-diplomas.
11:00 AM	Graduate Parade Walk	A heartwarming tradition visiting our elementary schools in caps and gowns.
5:45 PM	Senior Arrival	Park in the North Lot; meet in the Auditorium for medals

Time	Event	Details
		and class photos.
7:00 PM	Commencement Ceremony	Doors open at 6:00 PM (Activities Office entrance).

Arts & Academics

- **Spring Play "Our Town":** May 1 & 2 (7:00 PM), May 3 (2:00 PM) in the Auditorium.
- **Spring Band Concert:** Monday, May 4 at 7:00 PM (Auditorium).
- **Spring Vocal Concert:** Monday, May 11 at 7:00 PM (Auditorium).
- **Parent-Teacher Conferences:** Thursday, May 7 from 3:30 PM - 8:00 PM.
- **8th Grade Orientation:** Monday, May 18 (Welcome future Mustangs!).

Teacher Appreciation Week: May 4 - 8

Join us in thanking our incredible Mustang teachers for their dedication and impact on our students' lives. A small note or gesture goes a long way!

Important Calendar Reminders

- **Early Dismissals (1:00 PM):** May 6, 13, 20, and 27.
- **No School (Memorial Day):** Monday, May 25.
- **Last Day of School:** June 1.